

Final Research Report and Handover

Executive Summary

The research phase aimed to understand users' experiences, challenges, expectations, and preferences regarding digital loan application platforms. To achieve this, a mixed-method research approach was adopted, combining quantitative and qualitative methods.

The study consisted of:

- **42 survey responses** collected through an online questionnaire.
- **41 valid responses** analysed after excluding one participant who did not provide consent.
- **12 semi-structured interviews** to gather in-depth qualitative insights.
- Observation was **not conducted** due to ethical and privacy considerations associated with financial applications and personal banking information.

The combination of surveys and interviews provided a comprehensive understanding of user behaviour and expectations.

Research Method Summary

Research Activity	Outcome
Literature & Problem Understanding	Completed
Survey Design	Completed
Survey Responses	42 collected (41 analysed)
Semi-Structured Interviews	12 participants
Quantitative Analysis	Completed
Qualitative Thematic Analysis	Completed

Research Activity	Outcome
Research Findings	Completed

Key Research Findings

The following findings represent the most significant insights obtained from both the survey and interview analyses.

Finding	Evidence
Users expect greater transparency during the loan application process.	Survey & Interviews
Long approval times without updates cause frustration.	Survey & Interviews
Eligibility criteria are often difficult to understand.	Survey & Interviews
Users want real-time application status tracking.	Survey
Document submission is perceived as repetitive and confusing.	Survey & Interviews
Loan terminology and hidden charges are difficult for some users to understand.	Interviews
Participants value EMI calculators and eligibility checkers before applying.	Survey
Trust and security significantly influence willingness to upload financial documents online.	Survey & Interviews
Most participants would adopt a well-designed digital loan platform.	Survey

Interpretation

The research demonstrates that users are generally willing to use digital loan application platforms. However, they expect a process that is transparent, easy to understand, secure, and informative.

Both quantitative and qualitative findings consistently highlighted issues related to communication, documentation, and clarity. Rather than resisting digital services, users seek greater confidence and guidance throughout the application journey.

Prioritised Design Recommendations

High Priority

Recommendation	Research Justification
Real-time application tracking	Most requested feature; addresses approval uncertainty.
Loan eligibility checker	Helps users understand requirements before applying.
EMI calculator	Supports financial planning and informed decisions.
Document upload progress tracker	Reduces confusion during document submission.
Estimated approval timeline	Addresses concerns about long waiting periods.

Medium Priority

Recommendation	Research Justification
Plain-language explanations	Improves understanding of loan terms and charges.
Live chat support	Provides timely assistance during the application process.
Centralised information hub	Ensures consistent communication across channels.
Loan comparison feature	Helps users evaluate available loan options.

Research Limitations

Limitation	Description
Sample size	The survey analysed 41 valid responses and included 12 interview participants.
Geographic scope	Participants may not represent all regions or banking experiences.
Observation	Not conducted due to ethical and privacy concerns related to financial services.
Time constraints	The research reflects user experiences during the project period.

Handover Package – Sri Krishna Prabhu → Singh Aditya Randhir

Research Summary for UX Designer

Target Users

- First-time loan applicants.
- Returning loan applicants.
- Salaried employees.
- Self-employed individuals.
- Users applying through digital platforms.

Primary Pain Points

- Long approval waiting periods.
- Lack of application status visibility.
- Confusing eligibility criteria.
- Repetitive document submission.
- Limited transparency regarding fees and loan terms.
- Inconsistent communication across channels.

User Needs

- Transparent application process.
- Simple eligibility guidance.
- Continuous application updates.
- Secure document handling.
- Easy-to-understand financial information.
- Reliable customer support.

Design Opportunities

- Real-time status tracker.
- Eligibility checker.
- EMI calculator.
- Smart document upload workflow.
- Approval timeline estimation.
- Live chat support.
- Plain-language explanations.
- Clear fee and interest breakdowns.

Success Criteria for Singh Aditya Randhir

The design should enable users to:

- Understand the loan process without confusion.
- Track application progress at every stage.
- Submit documents confidently.
- Calculate repayments before applying.
- Receive timely updates and support.
- Trust the platform with sensitive financial information.